

Lecture 1 - Intro and Choosing Teams (1/14)

Identifying Connections

- starting point where they get info
- they make a survey and feed it to algo
 - ◻ algo matches up study partners/ people to choose
- split into algo and survey sections

Facilitating Interactions

- Using AI to make icebreakers based on shared interests
 - ◻ also used AI to continue interactions and nudge people to keep talking
- thought of adding room scheduling functionality that's pretty cool
- Karishma's research proj. also.

Managing Resources

- once you manage the resources you can use it to do more
- kinda giving reddit
- use AI to boost different resources so more people could gain from them
- active contributors to benefit the broader consumer

[Last One]

- don't really know what this one does.

★ select the team and fill out google sheets as well ★

- this is due by next Tues. by 4pm
- email it to her and Carl

Lecture 2 - Facilitating Interactions: Project Plan (1/21)

- Working prototype is up to us on what it could be representing
- Could be figma or could be actual code
 - We could write it in Python, JS, Java, etc
 - Start thinking of this as development
 - Start coordinating the MVP (**most viable product**)
 - We may not need to worry about getting user feedback, we could just get an algo that cycles through them to feed to a group
 - Maybe start collecting icebreakers or doing research on how people interact with specific types of icebreakers
 - Maybe introduce a time component that differs based off of the time-length of interactions
 - Introducing icebreakers as a check-in/touching base icebreakers as well
- Sometimes, MVP doesn't have to be very focused. It can be something just used to reach out to people and get a response from AI that aligns with the people themselves.

Breaking up work amongst ourselves:

Code: hardcode for 2 ppl based off of interest^{from the firm}
- ask AI to generate icebreakers
- show what the backend would look like
into figma
- linking is the hardest part²

make figma for front end,
then hardcode 2 people in backend
→ then give that to GPT and get
an icebreaker

• major, year, what are some interests
◦ demographic factors
when/they like to study, if they prefer remote
where

Lecture 3 - Slack Huddle Call Notes (1/28)

Main action items for the project as a whole:

- Working on project backend
- Working on frontend in Figma (completed at a later date – possibly after demo is due)

More Discussion on Backend

- Different tasks to be divided up for group members:
 - Creating the prompt to generate icebreakers with GPT
 - Manually creating the personalities of the two hardcoded people
 - Basic demographic factors: hobbies, major/minor, year, when they like to study, remote/in person/where they prefer to study, times they are free
 - Connecting the prompt to the GPT API key (**Jade**)
 - More on inputting side of backend
 - Calling the API and pushing the output out on the terminal for user to view

More Discussion on Frontend:

- Figma can be done at a later time
- We can use hardcoded users if we aren't able to get real users from Identifying Connections in time
- Figma doesn't have to be very serious, working backend code is what matters

Important dates to keep in mind:

- **PROJECT DEMO - FEB 11TH**

Lecture 4 - Guest Speaker + Project Ideation (2/4)

Additional ideas: allow the user to rate the generated version of the icebreakers. And ask for it to generate more prompts.

Answer to Questions:

Team 2: Facilitating Interactions

Prototype goal & key features

1. What types of interactions will your prototype facilitate? (i.e. icebreakers, brainstorming, project planning...)

- Planning on doing icebreakers of some sort to garner user interaction.
- We want to make our prototype to show how we can use AI to prompt icebreakers to get conversations started and continue interactions.

2. Will the prototype facilitate online/remote, in person, or both types? And how?

- We will ultimately produce more online interaction

- We want our users to talk to each other via text convos, messages, etc
3. How will AI be used to facilitate interactions?
- We want to use Generative AI technologies like a ChatGPT API to help listen in on a conversation and provide icebreakers.
 - The AI will use data entered by the individuals to facilitate personalized interactions.
4. What data will the prototype use facilitate interactions that is appropriate for the individuals involved?
- This is an example for the kind of data we need. We could potentially work with Identifying connections to add any specific questions etc, once we get working with the API and start prompt analysis.
 - name": "Alice",
"gender": "Female",
"year": "Sophomore",
"minor": "Business",
"location": "Remote",
"interests": ["Soccer", "Cooking", "Reading"]
5. Are you still planning to integrate user-specific availability, GT's study room reservation system, etc. from last semester?
- I'm pretty sure these are still things we're planning on implementing, but it will more so focus on getting the users together and in a consistent study group rather than booking a room for them for our prototype right now.

User flows & wireframes

6. What are the user scenario(s)/user flow(s) that you want to demonstrate through the prototype?
- Example user scenario: A person joins the app and is now an existing user, who has filled out their information, they have made connections and are now part of a group. The AI will provide an ice breaker to the user, based on their interests in order to prompt conversation for the group.
7. Are you aiming for an interactive prototype or just a visual walk through?
- We have a realistic goal of a visual prototype that walks people through the overall flow of the app. How people will be matched via the information they submit, how convos will be progressed, etc.
 - Test data, data flow, dev environment
8. What data do you plan to use to test the prototype? (i.e., real or synthetic)
- Input data vs. Output data
 - Input data is garnering more overall info about the people interacting with the app, and it will be synthetic data where we create potential profiles for users.
 - Output data will be the conversations farmed from matching users together, which will not be real for the prototype. In the prototype, the output will focus on the quality of the AI prompts and how well it can facilitate an interaction.
 - User prompts vs. System prompts
9. How are you going to obtain your dataset?
- Work with the Managing Resources/ Identify Connections team to garner some real data points from people like what was talked about in number (4)
10. What is your target sample size and attributes of the dataset?
- For now, we will create data profiles for people, which will be a size of about 10 people in order to demonstrate the functionality of our prototype.

Team 2: Facilitating Interactions - Prototype testing

1. What do you want to test? Define clear and measurable objectives to ensure your test plan will yield actionable

test results. For example:

- I want to test how well the students enjoyed the icebreakers by measuring/observing....
- I want to test the quality of AI generated icebreakers based on x, y, z measures
- I want to test the quality of the system/user prompts to generate icebreakers based on x, y, z measures
 - Our prototype will test the quality of AI generated by asking people for any feedback with icebreakers and ask them to rate it. We will create a form with ice breakers that the AI generates given prompts, and ask people to rate the prompts.
 - When we have real data, we want to have the people rate the prompt with a thumbs up or down and even allow them to regenerate a prompt.
 - Another potential idea for how to check for the quality of the prompt would be to determine how long the conversation lasted after the prompt was given.

[Link to Icebreaker Prompts per each pair](#)

[Link to Icebreaker Rating Prompt](#)

Prompt used to ChatGPT for icebreaker generation: Can you generate 3 unique icebreakers for these two students based on their common interests or information ? It is meant to begin/ continue text conversation.

Working on Figma (Me + Geeta) (Week of Feb 3rd)

- Want to include more pastel and calming colors
- Splitting the work up as, Geeta laying down rough structure of what we want app to be, me completely designing it
- Came upon the name **StudySync**
- Wanting the app to feel very collaborative and user friendly
 - Have an IG like convo system, so users already feel familiar with it
- Link to figma:
<https://www.figma.com/design/t4Ql2dU7Ep9zm4Gkdi6wPT/VIP-Prototype?node-id=9-1228&t=woCfemvZh1lw6t2T-0>

Lecture 6 - Speaker Notes, Project Ideation (Feb 4th)

- We currently have the form for generation, the UI form, and we have changed our code in a statistical analysis way
 - For the code – we are monitoring how much a user refreshes or asks for another icebreaker

- With this, we will possibly throw out icebreakers we don't like/ are getting skipped a lot by users
- This week's meeting gave us a lot of insight into how we should approach building out our prototype.
- The discussion about MVPs helped clarify that we didn't need to overcomplicate our first version — we should focus on core functionality.
- We talked through necessary data for the prototype, like user inputs (interests, classes, availability).
- I started looking into how the backend will handle the prompt generation for icebreakers. This included:
 - Reviewing potential API options for generation.
 - Figuring out how we'll collect and store user input data
- Notes for myself:
 - Keep the figma modular so it's easy to update later
 - Stay aligned with the rest of the team on what information the prototype will require from users.
 - Communicate with other subteams to get a good sense of how we can make a unilateral design

Lecture 7 - Prototype Presentations (Feb 11th)

- All teams presented their prototype progress this week.
- For our team, the main feedback centered around automation — removing unnecessary user interaction steps and also treating user conversations more casually
 - The icebreakers are a little hard to get a conversation going, begin with more casual ones
 - Also have an instance where the amount of “new” icebreakers generated are counted
 - Maybe scrap the entire thing after a user has regenerated so many timeless
- Suggestions were made to explore design choices more deeply, like the psychological impact of color (especially since we were using a purple theme).
- Action items moving forward:
 - Work on improving prompt automation for the backend.
 - Revisit the UI design in Figma with feedback in mind.
 - Coordinate with the Identifying Connections group so that our data and designs are consistent

Lecture 8 - Refining Test Plan (Feb 18th)

- Wasn't able to make to class today, but got filled in on what my group covered.
- Focused on refining the testing plan for our prototype.
- Clarified what we mean by “correctness” when it comes to icebreaker generation — specifically that the generated prompt should accurately reflect the user profile and inputs.
- Decided to create two forms for testing:
 - One for rating the quality of icebreakers.

- One for gathering feedback on the UI.
- My task:
 - Help draft the UI testing form and start sharing it with potential testers to gather feedback.

Lecture 9 - Test Plan Progress (Feb 25th)

- Discussed early test results and what adjustments we need to make to the prototype.
- We added a statistics file within our code to track user interactions — specifically tracking how often users skip an icebreaker.
- Feedback so far has been mixed — some icebreakers resonate well while others feel forced or generic.
- Next steps for me:
 - Continue collecting feedback from users.
 - Analyze which prompts get skipped the most and brainstorm improvements.
 - Start outlining our presentation for the next check-in.

Lecture 10 - Test Results Presentation (March 4th)

- Presented our findings from the past few weeks of testing.
- Key takeaways from feedback:
 - Users would prefer prompts that relate to their classes rather than just hobbies
 - UI needs to be adjusted to better fit mobile dimensions.
 - There should be an option for users to request a different type of prompt (class-based vs hobby-based).
- Moving forward, I'll be:
 - Helping give study perspective on the backend prompt generation logic to prioritize class-related prompts.
 - Helping build out a bank of pre-tested prompts for fallback options.
 - Also helping to move the figma model to StudyBuzz (identifying connections goal)

Lecture 11 - Final Presentation Planning (March 11th)

- Chloe will focus on getting a pin to generate a prompt
 - She will tell it to generate a prompt based off of more academic things (major, classes taken, etc)

- We will then use those generated prompts in our form and garner more and more responses
 - Things to ask: rank your courses in number of difficulty, what courses are you in, what section are you in, where you like to study (remote or in-person)
 - We will most likely need some type of class syllabus or schedule
- We should have the scalability to have groups of varying amounts of people
 - As of right now, we'll keep our code being in pairs and then people can form groups afterward
 - This is because it's easiest to generate icebreakers for a smaller amount of people
- A final stage could be us looking at the oscar state of courses, matching people based off of max courses that match between the two of them
- "Generate an icebreaker according to the interests" → tell chat to do this
- Update our forms
 - Waiting for the new prompt and then we'll update for each of the people
- Update the figma
 - Making the buttons bigger somehow

Lecture 11 - Progress Update + Guest Speaker (March 25th)

- Progress check-in:
 - Backend prompt generation updated to include user class info.
 - Began collecting more feedback with the updated prompt structure.
 - Synced with the Identifying Connections group for consistent UI theming.
- The guest speaker discussed concepts like transactive memory and collective intelligence — emphasized the importance of collaboration and knowing each team member's strengths.
- For me, this reinforced the need to stay connected with other subteams so that our work fits into the larger project seamlessly.
- Next steps:
 - Continue refining icebreaker prompts.
 - Gather more feedback on updated UI and backend functionality.

Lecture 12 - Demo + Presentation Planning (April 1st)

- Today's focus was preparing for our final demo and making sure both our code and UI are ready to be showcased clearly.

- Made a “personas” slide for everyone to use, seems like it makes sense and will be helpful for the presentations
- We decided that a video walkthrough would be the most effective way to present the functionality of our prototype. This will allow us to highlight both the technical and visual aspects of our work.
- As a team, we agreed to create shared user personas across all subteams. These will help establish context for how users move through the app and make the demo feel more cohesive.
- Our plan is to introduce the Facilitating Interactions (FI) subteam’s role at the start of the presentation, using the first four guiding questions from our original slide deck to explain our goals.
- We'll also include a "Future Directions" section in the presentation to outline areas for improvement and what we’d focus on if given more time.
- One issue we noted was the repetitive nature of some prompts — right now, clicking refresh often leads to similar outputs. We want to look into ways to fine-tune our prompt engineering so users get more varied and personalized results.
- The UI is still being refined, and we’re working toward a cleaner, more unified look that integrates well with the other subteams’ designs.

Action Items:

- Record and edit the demo video
- Finalize updates to the UI
- Design Canva slides for user personas that will be shown at the beginning of the presentation

Lecture 13 - Working on Demo (April 8th)

- Final push before the demo presentation.
- Worked on polishing the UI and reviewing slides for the presentation.
- We also began recording content for our final demo video.
- My work this week involved:
 - Helping ensure that the UI was clean and functional for the demo.
 - Running tests on the updated prompt generation to confirm stability.
- For next week:
 - Finalize and submit all project deliverables.
 - Practice presentation delivery.
 - Reflect on project progress and key takeaways for the semester.